FIRST NEWS

10 March 2026 | Daily Market Report

Wall Street Reversal — S&P 500 Erases $1 Trillion in Losses

Major U.S. indexes erased steep early losses to close firmly in the green on March 10, 2026. The catalyst was President Trump's signals that the 10-day U.S.-Israel-Iran military operation is "very complete" and significantly ahead of its original five-week schedule — sparking aggressive buying across risk assets.

Index	3/9/2026	3/10/2026	% Change
Dow Jones	47,502	47,740	+0.50%
S&P 500	6,740	6,795	+0.82%
NASDAQ	22,388	22,695	+1.37%
PCOMP (PSEi)	6,320	6,006	**-4.97%**
Nikkei (NKY)	55,620	52,728	-5.20%
SHCOMP	4,124	4,096	-0.68%
Hang Seng (HSI)	25,757	25,408	-1.35%
KOSPI	5,274	5,251	-0.44%
SENSEX	78,918	77,566	-1.71%
TWSE	33,599	32,110	-4.43%
ASX 200	8,551	8,732	+2.12%
BURSA KLCI	1,718	1,674	-2.56%
JCI (Jakarta)	7,585	7,337	-3.27%
STI (Singapore)	4,848	4,756	-1.90%
SET (Thailand)	937	918	-2.03%
VN-Index	1,767	1,652	**-6.51%**

Oil Market — Brent Crude Spike & De-Escalation

Global oil prices surged past $100 per barrel — reaching $119.46 intraday — the highest level since 2022. The spike was driven by severe supply disruptions from the escalating U.S.-Israel-Iran conflict. However, prices pulled back toward $90.42 as strategic reserve release discussions and de-escalation signals circulated.

- **WTI Crude surged +40.51% from $75.91 to $106.66 in a single session (3/5 to 3/6).**
- Brent crude spiked to $119.46 overnight — intraday moves exceeded 20%.
- Trump signaled willingness to ease certain sanctions to stabilize energy markets.
- Strategic petroleum reserve releases and de-escalation talk triggered partial pullback.

Asian Markets — Sharp Broad-Based Selloff

Despite Wall Street's recovery, Asian markets experienced a severe and broad-based downturn. Regional stock indices plunged as oil prices surpassed $100/bbl, raising fears of high inflation and slower economic growth across energy-importing nations.

- Vietnam VN30 Index: -6.51% — worst performer in the region.

- Nikkei (NKY): -5.20%, with chip giants Samsung Electronics & SK Hynix both -7%+.
- PSEi: -4.97% — crashed through 6,000 psychological support.
- TWSE (Taiwan): -4.43% | JCI (Indonesia): -3.27% | BURSA KLCI: -2.56%.
- ASX 200 (Australia) bucked the trend: +2.12% — benefiting as a net energy exporter.

Macro Outlook — Emerging Markets

Despite the acute pressure, major investment managers maintain a constructive long-term view. Pimco, Barings, and T. Rowe Price argue that the underlying fundamentals of emerging market economies remain sound and that the current volatility is event-driven rather than structural. A sustained $100/bbl oil shock would, however, severely strain Asian nations that rely heavily on energy imports and lack robust fiscal buffers.

PSEi Plunges 4.97% — ₱1.4 Trillion in Market Cap Erased

The Philippine Stock Exchange index (PSEi) fell 314 points or 4.97% to close at 6,006.22 on Monday, March 9, 2026. The benchmark briefly crashed through the critical 6,000-point psychological support level in early trading before recovering slightly. Just weeks earlier, on February 25, the PSEi had hit a 13-month high of 6,620. The selloff has wiped out nearly ₱1.4 trillion in market value since late February.

Metric	Value	Context
PSEi Close	**6,006.22**	-314 pts, -4.97%
Range (Today)	5,938 – 6,198	—
RSI (14)	**34.39**	Approaching oversold (<30)
Advancers	28	—
Decliners	**205**	Highly negative breadth
Unchanged	41	—
Market Breadth	28/205/41	Heavily bearish
Value Traded	₱11.08 Billion	—
Volume	2.53 Billion shares	—
Block Sales	₱1.32 Billion	—
USD/PHP	59.50 – 59.70	Peso under pressure
PHL 10yr Bond	**6.722% (+10.21%)**	Yield surge on risk-off

Sector Performance — All Gauges in the Red

- Holding Firms: -5.94% (steepest sectoral decline)
- All sectoral gauges posted losses across the board.
- Top Advancers: PERC +12.94%, ZHI +10.00%, PXP +9.80%, OPM +8.33%, FPI +8.00%
- Top Decliners: TCB2A -25.00%, FNI -15.46%, EGRN -14.89%, IMP -14.29%, CEBCP -5.77%

Active Stocks by Value

Stock	Value Traded (₱M)
ICT	1,390
BDO	885
MBT	723
BPI	582
SM	547
JFC	443
AC	328
SMPH	263
PLUS	240

Foreign Trade Flow

Foreign investors were net sellers on the PSEi. Net Foreign Buying (NFB) was negative at -₱1.58 billion for the session. Year-to-date (YTD) net foreign buying stands at $322.78 million.

Flow	Amount (₱)
Foreign Bought (FB)	4,597,972,511.87
Foreign Sold (FS)	6,179,873,835.97
Net Foreign Buying (NFB)	**-1,581,901,324.10**
Total Turnover	10,777,846,347.84
NFB (Session)	$26.608 million
Total FB (February)	$107.960 million
YTD NFB	$322.78 million

SmartWatch 3/10 — Technical Bounce Signals

A technical bounce in Asian markets is expected on the back of Wall Street's reversal. Watch the following names and potential rebound magnitudes:

- 6% bounce targets: AEV, NIKL, RRHI, LTG
- 5% bounce targets: APX, WEB, MEG, MBT
- 4% bounce targets: ICT, OGP, SGP, MER, TEL, PNB, MWC
- 3% bounce targets: GLO, JGS, AGI, AT
- 2% bounce targets: JFC, SECB, AP, CBC
- 1% bounce targets: PX

Philippines Policy Response

- President Marcos Jr. and Philippine lawmakers actively pursuing suspension of fuel excise taxes.
- Marcos seeking emergency executive powers to address fuel surcharges.
- DOE projects diesel price increase of ₱17–₱23 per liter.
- Fuel suppliers already quoting operators ₱80/liter vs. ₱53/liter pre-conflict.

Commodities — Metals & Agriculture (3/5 to 3/6/2026)

Commodity	3/5/2026	3/6/2026	% Change
WTI Crude ($/bbl)	75.91	106.66	**+40.51%**
Gold (Comex)	5,171	5,072	-1.91%
Silver (Comex)	84.01	81.52	-2.96%
Platinum Spot	2,178	2,050	-5.88%
Copper (Comex)	590	564.8	-4.27%
Nickel	7.8151	7.7597	-0.71%
Coal	138	135.25	-1.99%
Corn	443.75	460.5	+3.77%
Wheat	568.25	616.75	+8.53%
Cocoa	3,060	3,230	+5.56%
Sugar	13.73	14.10	+2.69%

Currency & Bond Markets

Currency Pair	3/4/2026	3/9/2026	% Change
USD/JPY	157.68	158.10	+0.64%
USD/PHP	58.433	59.488	+0.06%
USD/CNY	6.9171	6.9092	+0.24%
EUR/USD	1.1603	1.1587	-0.35%

10-Year Bond	3/9/2026	3/10/2026	% Change
Philippines	6.099%	6.722%	**+10.21%**
United States	4.187%	4.106%	-1.93%

Individual company analysis and investment recommendations from DA Market Securities research.

ACEN

₱2.44

Net income plunges 60% in 2025 as soft spot prices overwhelm output gains

ACEN's 2025 consolidated net income fell to ₱3.8B from ₱9.36B (-60%). Revenues declined 14% to ₱32B. The drop was driven by softer spot prices in PH & Australia, weaker solar irradiation, offline wind assets in N. Luzon, and a ₱2.7B impairment on two Vietnam wind projects. However, recurring net income rose 4% to ₱6.3B; core EBITDA climbed 17% to ₱22.5B. Renewable output reached 7,009 GWh (+24% YoY). Q4 2025 net income surged 64% YoY. ACEN holds 57% GEOP market share.

Recommendation: NEUTRAL / BUY MEDIUM-LONG TERM. Recurring income rose 4% — underlying business is sound. Headline 60% drop is partly noise (impairments, one-offs). Q4 trajectory encouraging (+64%). Re-enter on price weakness if spot price environment normalizes.

FGEN

₱17.14

Scales back Prime Infra hydro investment to ₱61.9B at revised 33% stake

FGEN revised its deal with Prime Infrastructure Capital (Razon Group): from a 40% stake at ₱75B to a 33% equity interest in Prime Hydropower Energy, Inc. (PHEI) at ₱61.875B. The restructured deal covers the 1,400-MW Pakil (Laguna) and 600-MW Wawa (Rizal) pumped storage hydro projects — both certified as energy projects of national significance. Payment structure: ₱16.5B initial cash, ₱24.75B via SLCs (2027 & 2029), ₱20.625B in tranches. FGEN's 2026 capex guidance remains at ₱41.7B.

Recommendation: POSITIVE LONG-TERM. Deal scaling is prudent capital management — FGEN preserves balance sheet while retaining strategic exposure to 2,000 MW of future clean storage capacity. Wawa and Pakil are among the largest pumped hydro projects in PH history.

MER

₱590.00

Partners with Korea's KHNP & KEXIM for nuclear energy development

Meralco signed a tripartite MOU with Korea Hydro & Nuclear Power (KHNP) and the Export-Import Bank of Korea (KEXIM) on March 4. Collaboration covers reactor design, regulatory frameworks, site selection, business modeling, and training. Target: first Philippine nuclear kWh by 2032. MER's NEST program sends FISSION scholars to KEPCO's KINGS graduate school starting March 2026. Near-term catalyst: ERC rate reset ruling expected June–July 2026 (₱2.34/kWh tariff hike covering ₱247B capex).

Recommendation: BUY ON WEAKNESS. Nuclear pivot is strategically sound — diversifies from volatile LNG/coal inputs and aligns with PH energy security goals. Watch April rate impact from oil-exposed fuel mix (60% gas, 20–25% coal).

CNVRG

₱13.20

2025 net income +9.6% to ₱11.9B; guides 8–10% revenue growth in 2026

Converge reported solid 2025 results: revenues ₱44.8B (+10.2% YoY), net income ₱11.9B (+9.6%), EBITDA ₱27B (margin: 60.4%), ROIC 17.7%. Residential subs: 2.98M (+428,417 net adds). Enterprise revenues: ₱7.4B (+20.3%) — fastest-growing segment. For 2026: 8–10% revenue growth guidance; ₱18–₱23B capex for up to 900,000 additional fiber ports in Visayas & Mindanao. DICT named Converge national broadband leader for 2025. Shares fell 4.49% on Monday despite strong results — macro risk-off.

Recommendation: POSITIVE / ACCUMULATE ON WEAKNESS. Enterprise growth 20%+ is the key catalyst. 60%+ EBITDA margins and 17%+ ROIC are best-in-class. Selloff is macro-driven. Visayas/Mindanao expansion de-risks geographic concentration.

ALLHC

₱1.30

AC Logistics opens Davao cold storage facility — largest in Mindanao

AC Logistics Holdings Corp. and Glacier Megafridge (GMI) inaugurated a cold storage facility in Panabo City, Davao del Norte. Capacity: 11,798 pallet positions — among the largest in Mindanao. Serves food processing, agriculture, aquaculture, retail, and manufacturing. GMI (84% stake acquired January 2026) operates 12 facilities nationwide with 75,000-pallet total capacity. Ayala Corp. (AC) fell 6.88% on Monday to ₱501 due to broader market weakness.

Recommendation: MILDLY POSITIVE. Cold chain infrastructure is a structural growth story in Mindanao. Post-harvest losses cost PH agriculture billions annually. AC decline reflects macro selloff, not company-specific issues.

FEU

₱800.00

Acquires 60.34% stake in Bataan college for ₱156M

FEU signed an MOA to acquire a majority stake in Bataan Peninsula Educational Institution (BPEII), operating as the University of Nueva Caceres–Bataan. FEU will purchase 76.92% of the school's land for ₱50M and subscribe to 39,500 shares for ₱106M. Final equity interest: 60.34%. This follows FEU's October 2025 acquisition of a 51% stake in Higher Academia, Inc. in San Fernando, Pampanga. FEU group enrollment hit nearly 60,000 students — highest since pre-pandemic. 1H FY2025-26 net income dipped 3% to ₱635M due to higher personnel and program expansion costs.

Recommendation: MILDLY POSITIVE. Provincial expansion strategy (Bataan, Pampanga, Batangas) is sound — demand for quality private education outside Metro Manila is growing. ₱156M deal is small relative to FEU's balance sheet.

CEB/PAL/2GO

AVOID

Fare hikes up to 25% as fuel costs surge on Middle East conflict

Multiple Philippine shipping lines implemented emergency fare increases: Starlite Ferries +25% (from March 10); Montenegro Shipping Lines +10–20% (March 23); FastCat rate hikes (March 6, citing 40% fuel cost surge); Roble Shipping & Super Shuttle Ferry +20% surcharges. OceanJet suspended Cebu-Leyte and Cebu-Bohol routes through March 20. Fuel quoted at ₱80/liter vs. ₱53/liter pre-conflict. IATA global aviation net margin 2026: only 3.9%.

Recommendation: NEGATIVE near-term for airlines & maritime operators. Fuel surcharges compress margins; route suspensions threaten revenue. Avoid CEB and PAL near-term — watch for Q1 guidance downgrades. 2GO/Chelsea Logistics downstream exposure elevated.

ATRAM

Fund Market

SDGF outperforms PSEi since 2021 launch; ₱363B AUM, 48% feeder fund market share

ATRAM's PH Sustainable Development and Growth Fund (SDGF) — the first UN SDG-aligned equity fund in the Philippines — has consistently outperformed the PSEi since February 2021. In 2024 alone, SDGF returned 17.61% vs. PSEi's 1.22%. The fund selects stocks via ATRAM's proprietary SDG scoring methodology and holds ~₱300M in AUM. ATRAM overall manages ₱363B with 48% market share in feeder funds.

Recommendation: POSITIVE for ESG/sustainability-oriented investors. SDGF's track record demonstrates sustainability screens add alpha in PH equities. Potential portfolio overlap with names we favor: MER, GLO, FGEN, ALI.

Near-Term: Caution — Event-Driven Volatility

The current market dislocation is macro and oil-driven — not a fundamental deterioration in Philippine equities. The PSEi selloff of nearly 5% in a single session reflects the acute shock of oil prices surpassing $100/bbl and escalating Middle East tensions. However, with RSI approaching oversold levels (~34) and key technicals stretched, the market may be setting up for a technical bounce.

Key Risks to Monitor

- Sustained oil above $100/bbl: Would fuel inflation, widen the current account deficit, and pressure the peso further (USD/PHP already at 59.50–59.70).
- PHL 10-year bond yield surging to 6.722% (+10.21%): Indicates rising risk premium and could increase borrowing costs for corporates.
- Middle East conflict escalation: Any further deterioration would extend the selloff and delay market recovery.
- Fuel excise tax suspension outcome: Approval by Congress could provide relief to transport and consumer sectors.

Opportunities in the Weakness

- Oversold conditions on PSEi RSI (34.39) and AREIT Weekly RSI (35.97) may present accumulation opportunities.
- CNVRG: Fundamentally strong 2025 results ignored due to macro selloff — accumulate on weakness.
- MER: Nuclear pivot and upcoming ERC rate reset are structural catalysts — buy on weakness.
- FGEN: Scaled-back hydro deal reflects prudent balance sheet management — positive long-term.
- SmartWatch bounce candidates: AEV, NIKL, RRHI, LTG (6%), APX, WEB, MEG, MBT (5%).

Sectors to Avoid Near-Term

- Airlines & Maritime (CEB, PAL, 2GO): Fuel surcharges and route suspensions compress margins.
- Holding Companies: Steepest sectoral decline (-5.94%); leverage amplifies macro risk.
- Highly import-dependent industrials: Vulnerable to peso weakness and oil price pass-through.

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